



INDIA SETTLED, ENGLAND HAS MORE QUESTIONS THAN ANSWERS

Four debutants stepped up in the absence of key players, signalling **a promising future for Indian cricket** amid the ongoing WTC cycle (2023-25).

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The finale in Dharamsala had all the trappings of India's unyielding dominance at home, which stretched to a 17th series win on the bounce, spilling over into its 12th year. The contest was wrapped up in nine sessions; the Indian spin troika had nabbed 18 wickets, and the opposition batters capitulated meekly twice in three days.

Though triumphs at home in the longest format have come to be seen as a rite of passage in this part of the world, this 4-1 series win marked a crucial inflection point in the trajectory of Indian Test cricket that went beyond the temporal gains of consolidating the top spot in the World Test Championship (WTC) standings, toppling Australia to claim the pole position in the ICC rankings, and stopping the evangelism of Bazball in its tracks.

With India missing 227 precious

Test caps in Virat Kohli, Mohammed Shami, and KL Rahul (ruled out after the first Test), four of the five debutants in the series not only filled the void with distinction but also pointed to a bright future on the horizon for a side that could usher in a period of transition following the ongoing WTC cycle (2023-25).

They weren't just hastily slotted into stop-gap measures but held the promise of taking on specific roles in the long term. Sarfaraz Khan lived up to the hype of his highly anticipated